



**MASTERMIND
INDIA**

Spirit of India Special

AJIT NARAYANAN, 28

INNOVATION

Avaz, a communication device for those with cerebral palsy

COST

Rs 30,000

WHAT IT DOES

The device with a graphical interface, a processor, software and a USB-based non-contact switch can be used by children with poor motor skills to construct sentences



SPEECH WEAVER

By Natascha Shah

Unlike other students of Class XII, Rohit Parek Jain can't communicate orally. He has cerebral palsy which has resulted in a speech impediment. The solutions available to Rohit include manual methods such as flip charts

with alphabets and pictures, some computer-based software and voice output communication aids. All these have their limitations. The manual methods are excruciatingly slow and rather ineffective as the focus of the child and the interlocutor is on the flip chart rather than on each other. The computer-based software has

limited mobility and is difficult to operate independently. Only a limited number of messages can be recorded in a voice output system.

However, Rohit does not have to wait too long to overcome these difficulties. Help has come in the form of a device called Avaz which enables him to speak one full sentence for the